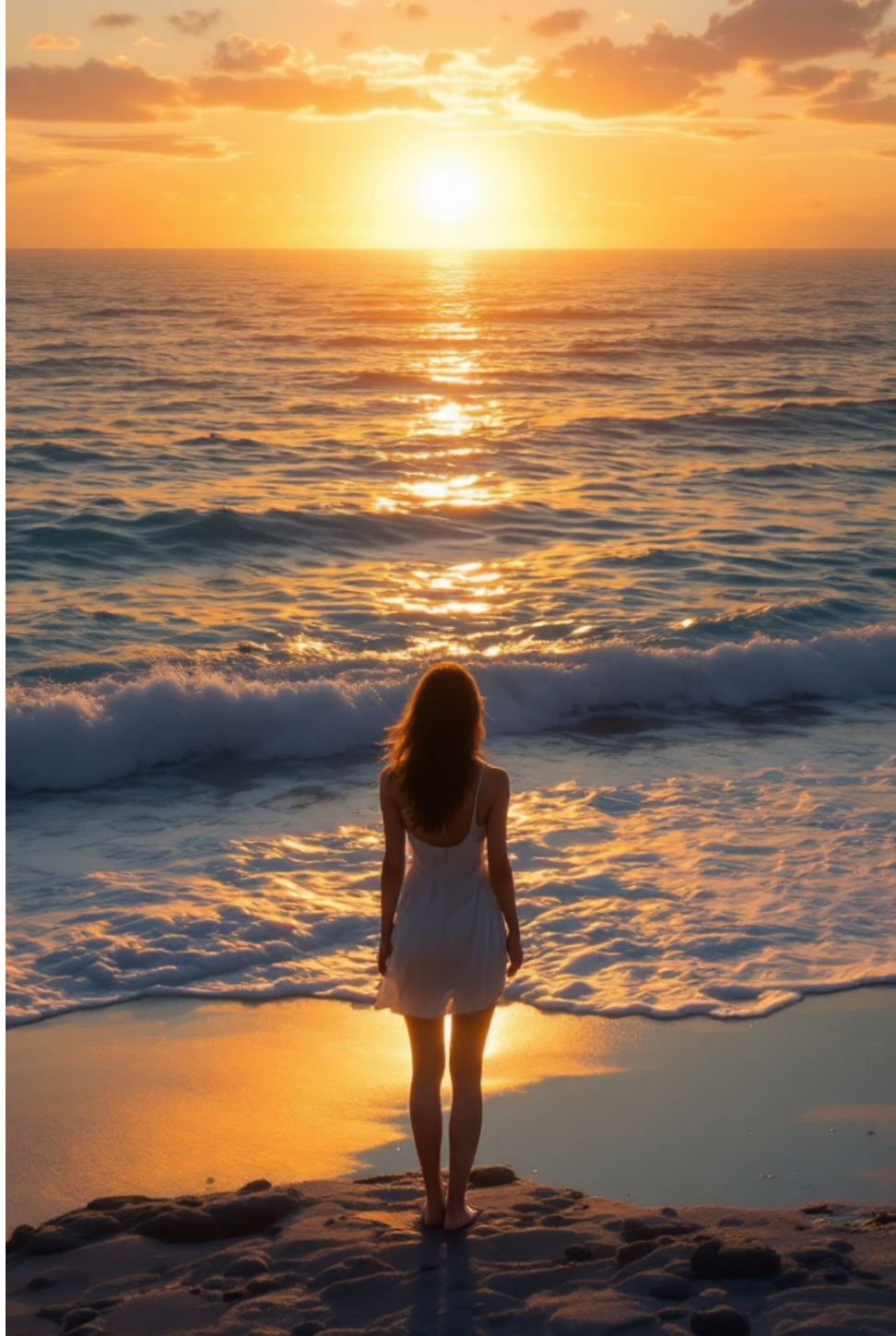
Panic Attacks: Understanding & Overcoming the Fear of Fear

An 8-lesson CBT-based course for understanding panic physiology and breaking the panic cycle



What Happens During a Panic Attack

Your heart pounds. You can't breathe. You feel dizzy, your hands tingle, a wave of dread washes over you. You think: *"I'm having a heart attack"* or *"I'm losing control."*

You Are Not Dying

Despite how terrifying it feels, a panic attack poses no physical danger to your body or heart.

You Are Not Going Crazy

Your mind is functioning — it is simply misreading a false alarm as a genuine threat.

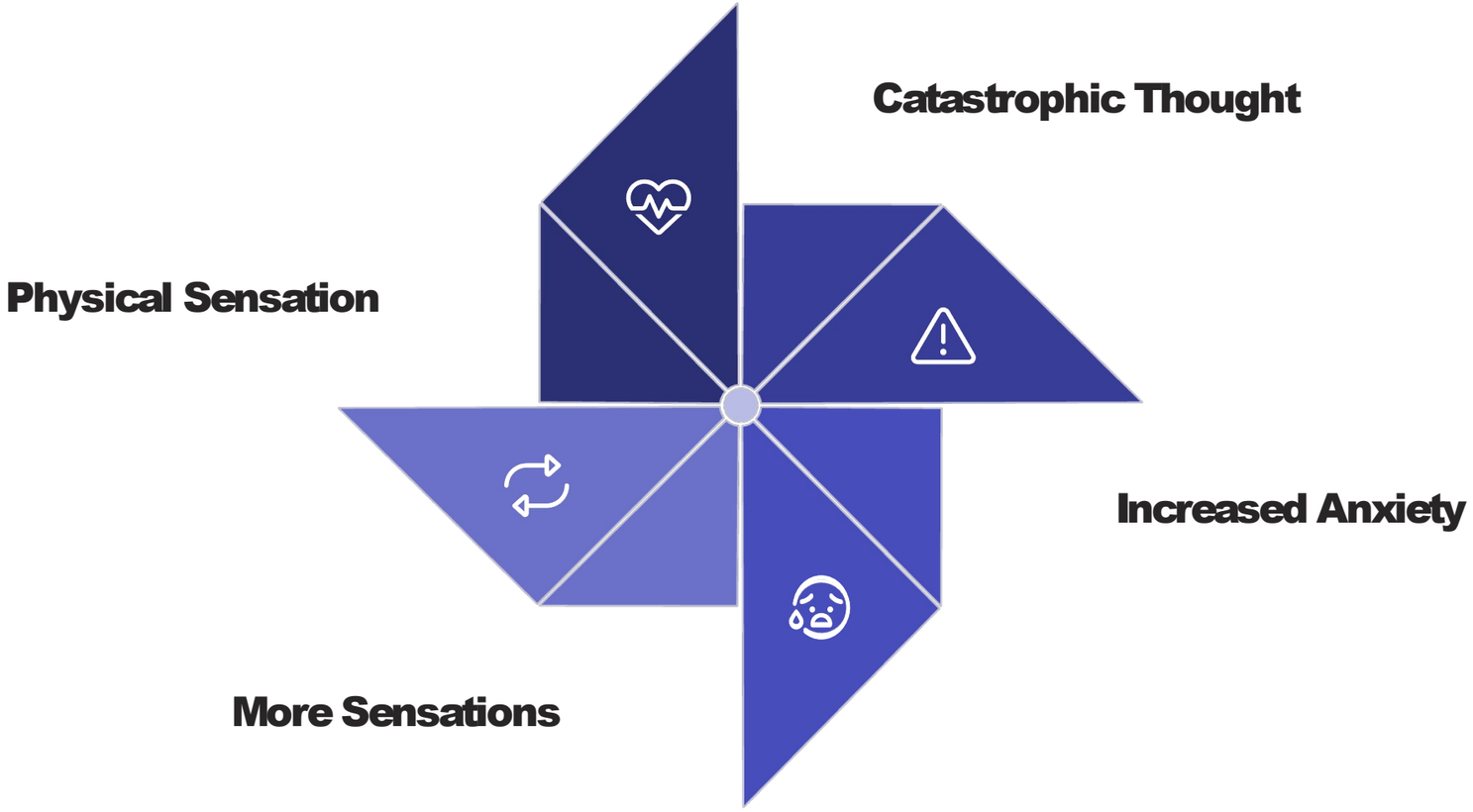
Your Alarm System Misfired

Your body's fight-or-flight response activated at the wrong time — with no real danger present.

> A panic attack is your fight-or-flight response activated at the wrong time. The danger feels real — but it isn't.

The Panic Cycle

A panic attack doesn't just happen once — it creates a self-reinforcing loop known as the **"fear of fear" cycle.** This cycle is what turns individual panic attacks into full panic disorder.



Each step in the cycle feeds the next. The more you fear the sensations, the more intense they become — and the more convinced you are that something is truly wrong. **Breaking this cycle is the core of treatment.**

> Understanding the panic cycle is the first and most powerful step toward recovery. Once you see the loop, you can interrupt it.

What You'll Learn in This Course

This 8-lesson program covers everything you need to understand, manage, and ultimately overcome panic disorder using evidence-based CBT techniques.

Physiology of Panic

The amygdala, stress hormones, and the fight-or-flight response explained.

Why Sensations Are Harmless

Why panic sensations feel dangerous — and why they are completely safe.

Cognitive Restructuring

How to break the fear-of-fear cycle by challenging catastrophic thoughts.

Interoceptive Exposure

Reducing fear of your own body sensations through gradual, safe exposure.

Breathing & Grounding

Practical techniques to use during an attack to restore calm quickly.

Lifestyle & Long-Term Plan

Caffeine, sleep, alcohol triggers — and building a lasting maintenance plan.

The Science of Recovery

Panic disorder is one of the most treatable anxiety conditions. The research is clear, consistent, and deeply encouraging.

10

Minutes to Peak

Panic attacks typically peak within 10 minutes — no matter how endless they feel in the moment.

30

Minutes to Resolve

Most attacks fully resolve within 20–30 minutes. Your body cannot sustain the panic response indefinitely.

90%

CBT Success Rate

CBT for panic disorder achieves a 70–90% success rate — among the highest of any psychological treatment.

Physically Harmless

Despite the overwhelming sensations, panic attacks **cannot harm you physically.** Your heart, lungs, and brain are safe. The symptoms — though distressing — are the result of adrenaline, not damage.

Clinically Proven Techniques

The techniques in this course are the **same ones used in clinical settings worldwide.** They are not self-help guesswork — they are the gold-standard interventions recommended by psychiatrists and psychologists globally.

Course Structure

8 lessons. 8–10 hours. Evidence-based. Self-paced. Work through each module at your own speed, revisiting any lesson as many times as you need.

Lesson 1
Panic Physiology

Lesson 2
The Panic Cycle

Lesson 3
Challenging Catastrophic Thoughts

Lesson 4
Interoceptive Exposure

Lesson 5
Breathing & Grounding

Lesson 6
Reducing Avoidance

Lesson 7
Lifestyle Factors

Lesson 8
Long-Term Management

This course uses the same evidence-based CBT protocols applied in clinical settings worldwide. You don't need a therapist in the room — you need the right knowledge, applied consistently.